writing. In addition to her significant contributions to Afro-diasporic communities in Germany and elsewhere, Lorde's own evolving process of creation included self-reflection and poetic revision helmed in divided Berlin.[49]

The profound transformation Lorde experienced in Berlin, from unsteadiness to a sense of purpose, can be traced to the way she interacted with the material contours and physical landscape of the city and translated them into her writing. In one edited journal entry, listed as June 7, 1984, printed from *A Burst of Light*, she meditates on her own struggle for survival. "I am listening to what fear teaches. I will never be gone. I am a scar, a report from the frontlines, a talisman, a resurrection." She weighs her own mortality and seeks legacy beyond her own time, as narrated from her vantage at that point in West Berlin. Lorde lingers on the themes of fear and survival while nodding to the geopolitical currents of divided Berlin and her place there. She writes, "And what does that war teach when the bruised leavings jump an insurmountable wall where the glorious Berlin chestnuts and orange poppies hide detection wires that spray bullets which kill?"[50] For the first time, she offers the Berlin Wall in her writing in the city. By introducing the Wall in her journal, she locates the divide as a place to weigh legacies of war she encounters in the city and to consider the transcendent forms of nature in which she is immersed while navigating the traumatized urban landscape. In this entry, she aims to shape her legacy and fight for survival, pushing ahead to heal herself and others, by looking at the Wall.

Confronting fear is central to Lorde's mission in Berlin, and the backdrop of the walled city becomes a venue for engagement with this emotion. But in unedited versions of this journal entry contained in her archive, "the wall" was pluralized, listed as "insurmountable walls" in both the entry of her personal journal and page proof from the book.[51] Both her original phrasing and her revision suggest the actual wall system's intricate and myriad modes of border control, including its multiple walls, but she also powerfully alludes to other lines of division she encounters. Lorde's understanding of her experience, living in Berlin across such multiple lines of division, may also include moments of refracted mirroring between lines of private and publicly edited poetic work. Lorde uses revision as a regular facet of her creative process. She treats the Wall as a formidable structure, though rarely as "insurmountable," as read through her revisions that frame the divided